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Guide 6 — Comparison & Savings, the simple version

How Mobile Match Algeria lets users put plans side by side, see the differences as charts, and know how much they would save — in plain words, with the research, a worked example, and ready answers for the jury.

1. The idea, in three sentences

Once a user has a few candidate plans, they need to compare them fairly and see which is the best deal. The platform shows the selected plans **side by side in a table**, draws a small **bar chart per metric** (price, data, ...) so the differences are visual, and — when the comparison is started from the recommendations page — adds a **savings** figure showing how much cheaper each plan is than the user's monthly budget.

2. How it works — four steps

1. **Pick plans to compare** — the user ticks “Compare” on offer cards; the chosen ids are passed to the compare page (/compare?ids=...).
 2. **Side-by-side table** — each plan becomes a column; the rows are the attributes (price, data, calls, SMS, validity, network), and each plan's column is tinted its operator colour so the eye can follow it down.
 3. **One bar chart per metric** — a small Recharts bar chart for price and for data volume; the best bar for that metric is highlighted, so “cheapest” and “most data” are obvious at a glance.
 4. **Savings** — if the user arrived from the recommendations page (so their budget is known), an extra **annual-savings** bar chart is drawn and each recommended plan card shows its monthly, yearly, and percentage saving.
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3. The savings formula

Savings are measured against the user's **monthly budget**:

- **Monthly saving** = budget – plan price (never below 0)
- **Annual saving** = monthly saving × 12
- **Percentage** = monthly saving ÷ budget

So a plan that costs less than the budget shows how much is left over each month, per year, and as a share of the budget. It is plain arithmetic — nothing is estimated or invented.

4. Where each part comes from (the research)

Part	What it does	Comes from
Side-by-side table	compare like-for-like	the standard comparison-table pattern in interface design (Nielsen Norman)
One chart per metric	turn numbers into a visual ranking	information visualisation principles (Munzner, 2014); visual comparison of multi-attribute items / rankings (Gratzl et al., 2013 — LineUp)
Savings figures	budget – price, ×12, and %	plain arithmetic against the user's stated budget (ours)

What is *ours* is the configuration: which metrics get a chart, that the best value is highlighted, and that savings are computed against the user's monthly budget.

5. A worked example

The user's budget is **6,000 DA/month** and they compare three plans, having come from the recommendations page. For the top plan, **Dima Ooredoo at 750 DA**:

- **Monthly saving** = $6,000 - 750 = 5,250$ DA
- **Annual saving** = $5,250 \times 12 = 63,000$ DA
- **Percentage** = $5,250 \div 6,000 = 88\%$ below budget

The table shows the three plans in columns; the price chart makes 750 DA the shortest (best) bar, the data chart highlights whichever plan carries the most GB, and the annual- savings chart makes the biggest saver the tallest bar.

6. The files

- [compare/compare-content.tsx](#) — the compare page: the side-by-side table, the per-metric Recharts bar charts (MiniChart), and the annual-savings chart.
 - [recommendation.ts](#) — computes each plan's monthly savings (budget – price) for the recommendation cards.
 - [recommend/page.tsx](#) — shows the monthly / yearly / percentage saving on each recommended plan.
 - [offer-card.tsx](#) — the “Compare” button that selects plans.
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7. Jury questions — ready answers

- **Why charts and a table, not just a table?** The table gives exact values; the bar charts turn those into an instant visual ranking (shortest price bar, tallest data bar), which is faster to read. Tables for precision, charts for the glance.

- **Why does the savings chart only sometimes appear?** Savings need a budget to compare against. That is only known when the comparison is launched from the recommendations page (which has the user's profile), so the savings chart is shown only there.
- **How is the saving calculated — is it estimated?** No estimation: it is budget minus the plan's price, times twelve for the year, and as a percentage of the budget.
- **What if a plan costs more than the budget?** The saving is floored at 0 (no negative savings shown).
- **Which charting library?** Recharts (a React charting library); each chart is one metric with the best performer highlighted.

Next guide: responsive design & accessibility, or web data aggregation. Tell me which.